

Sujal Khatiwada

Software Engineer | Developer Educator | Curriculum Designer

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PROFILE

Software engineer with 6+ years of experience building web apps for real clients. I also design courses and teach programming, and web development with a focus on basics done properly and learning by building approach to create engaging learning experiences.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

PHP documentation: issue report (accepted & fixed)

Feb 2025

Found a bad BCMath example on the PHP 8.4 release docs. It broke under `declare(strict_types=1)`. I opened an issue on the official docs repo; the sample was corrected and merged.

[View PHP docs issue on GitHub](#)

sujal/validation: PHP validation library

Open source · MIT

A PHP validation library built around reusable Rule classes. You build an immutable Schema of Fields, hand it to a ValidationEngine, and get pass/fail results with messages instead of a long chain of if statements.

- Built for PHP 8.2+, no framework required.
- Rules like Required, Email, Min/Max, Confirmed, Nested paths, and wildcards (e.g. `items.*.email`).
- Designed around SOLID boundaries so new rules are new classes, not engine changes.
- Covered with PHPUnit tests (`composer test`).

Stack: PHP 8.2+, Composer, PHPUnit

[View project on GitHub](#)

CASE STUDY

Online learning platform (New York client)

Upwork

Government school in New York · used daily by hundreds of students

Built a learning site for a New York client used in a government school. Students practice languages, science, social studies, and more with vocabularies, audio, visuals, and other interactive activities: less memorizing, more using what they learn.

- Student side for learning, plus a full-featured admin panel to manage content. Some of the features include CSV file uploads, AJAX audio uploads, multi-file drag-and-drop for audio, and bulk photo uploads.
- Suggested the learning methods to the client, then coded them into the product.
- Hundreds of students use it in class on a normal school day.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JS, jQuery

SELECTED WORK

- **Upwork:** 25+ client projects finished, mostly backend, REST APIs, and front-end work.
- **Udemy:** Course instructor for 43,000+ students, teaching programming from the ground up.
- **Community workshops:** Gave training through ITSNP (IT Students of Nepal) and Code for Change (Nepal) on JavaScript and problem-solving.

PROJECTS

REST API for an e-commerce store

Solo project · self-made

This one is a store API I built myself: products, cart/checkout, user accounts. Backend is in PHP, Symfony, and API Platform framework.

- Stripe handles card payments; I also added coupon codes.

- Product images are stored on AWS S3 instead of the application server.
- Auth uses tokens. For access checks I relied on Symfony voters, and I wrote a few custom validators when the built-in ones fell short.
- Order confirmations and account emails go out through Symfony Mailer.
- In CartRepository I reworked a query that was causing an N+1 issue.
- I followed SOLID in places where it helped the code stay easier to change later.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, Symfony, API Platform, HTML, CSS, JS, Stripe, AWS S3, Symfony Mailer

[View project on GitHub](#)

• Service Finder (FindNearMe)

Solo project · self-made

Prototype of an app to find nearby services (for example a salon), with ratings and basic verification. I wanted local results that feel more trustworthy than a plain web search. Later I may add certified staff badges and a live “how busy are they” signal.

- Search by name, tags, or location.
- Business owners get a panel for listings, photos, map, and email verification.
- Users leave reviews and votes. Admins approve listings, manage categories, and handle users.
- Core PHP, MySQL, and HTML/CSS/JS (mix of OOP and procedural). I skipped a big framework so I could focus on the product first.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JS, PHPMailer, TinyMCE, Leaflet, Fancybox

[View project on GitHub](#)

• Vue Drive (file manager)

Solo project · self-made

A Google Drive–style app I built to practice Vue end to end: upload files, nest folders, search, star items, and open recent files. Frontend is Vue 3 with Vite, Vue Router, and Pinia. Backend is a small Express API with JWT login/register and Multer for uploads.

- Create folders inside folders, rename items, and delete files.
- Search and sort files; mark important ones as starred.
- Upload with a drop zone and progress UI.
- Login and register with hashed passwords and token auth.

Stack: Vue 3, Vite, Pinia, Vue Router, Express, JWT, bcrypt, Multer, Axios

[View project on GitHub](#)

• 2feat.com

Frontend only · team project

On [2feat.com](#) my job was the custom HTML/CSS/JS. When that was done I handed it over. React was someone else’s lane.

- Got the markup and scripts ready for the rest of the team.
- Sat with React + backend folks when they plugged things together.

Stack: HTML, CSS, JS | React: other teammates

[Visit 2feat.com](#)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer at Upwork

Aug 2020 to Present

- Completed 25+ projects for clients: backend work, REST APIs, and responsive UIs.
- Write code with OOP, SOLID, dependency injection, and clean structure when the project needs it.
- Integrated tools like Stripe and Symfony Mailer in live apps.
- Use PHPUnit for unit tests and also test REST APIs end to end before handing work over.
- On team jobs I collect requirements, clear up scope, and keep handoffs tidy with remote teammates.
- Talk directly with clients abroad about what to build and how to ship it.

TEACHING & CURRICULUM DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Instructor & Curriculum Designer

2018 – Present

Independent / Online & Community Platforms

- Write courses that start with fundamentals and push students to solve real problems.
- Teach mixed ages, including school kids: from first programs to full projects.
- Build lesson paths that get harder over time so people don't get stuck or bored.
- Coach learners on how software is actually built and delivered in practice.

Udemy Instructor

- 43,000+ students in 150+ countries.
- Main course is programming basics: lots of examples, not much fluff.
- Reviews usually say the teaching is easy to follow. That's what I'm aiming for.

Community & Local Organization Teaching

- **Code for Change (Nepal):** Ran JS workshops in Kathmandu. Mix of interactive sessions and hands-on coding sessions.
- **IT Students of Nepal:** Sessions on JavaScript on a LIVE workshop of 1 month duration.

EDUCATION

London Metropolitan University: BSc (Hons.) Computing

2023

First Class Honours

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend:** PHP, Symfony, API Platform, MySQL, REST APIs, Doctrine ORM, Stripe payment integration, Symfony Mailer
- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript (Vanilla), Vue.js, Responsive UI Design
- **Testing:** PHPUnit (unit testing), functional testing of REST APIs
- **Core Concepts:** SOLID principles, OOP, Design Patterns, Dependency Injection
- **Tools:** Git, GitHub, Composer, Linux Command Line

SOFT SKILLS

- **Collaboration:** Asking the right questions up front, remote work, client calls, handing work across cleanly
- **Teaching & training:** Workshops, lesson writing, making sure people can still use the skill a month later
- **Communication:** I can talk to a beginner or a senior without switching into buzzword mode
- **Mentorship:** Freshers and switchers usually need a map, not another random YouTube playlist
- **Problem-solving:** Turn unclear requests into working software

LANGUAGES

- **Nepali:** Native language
- **English:** Professional level, both writing and speaking/communication
- **Hindi:** Good communication skill
- **Bhojpuri:** Fluent
- **Bajika:** Speaks and understands
- **Maithili:** Basic to intermediate understanding; limited speaking exposure

LINKS

[Udemy Instructor Profile](#)

[Upwork Freelance Profile](#)

[LinkedIn Profile](#)

[GitHub Repository](#)